

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

Recd 12/25/00 wpl

Species: Lesser Black-backed Gull (*Larus fuscus graellsii*)**Date:** 3 November 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** ?**Plumage:** Def. Basic**Locality:** Pueblo Res.**Elevation:** about 5000'**Nearest town:** Pueblo West**County:** Pueblo**Time observed:** about 10:00 - 10:05 MST**Duration of observation:** about 5 minutes

Description: While looking for the Pomarine Jaeger at the reservoir from the Sailboard Launching Area, I found the adult Lesser Black-backed Gull (LBBG) on the water that had been present for some time, originally found by Doug Faulkner.

The bird was a large, white-headed gull, larger than nearby CAGUs, and much larger than nearby Ring-billed Gulls (RBGU). The bird's white head was extensively streaked with dark brown. The eyes were yellow, as was the bill, the latter having a large, red gonydeal spot. The bill also had a pronounced gonydeal angle, unlike the bills of the CAGUs. The mantle was a couple shades darker gray than that of the nearby CAGUs. There was a strong contrast from mantle color to wingtip color. The wings were long, extending well beyond the tail tip. The wingtips were extensively black, much more so than on the nearby RBGUs, but about as extensive as that on the CAGUs. The white trailing edge to the wing was fairly thin, as were the white primary tips and scapular and tertial crescents. The underparts were all white, other than some pale brown streaking on the neck. The legs were yellow.

Similar species eliminated: California Gull (CAGU) eliminated by size, mantle color, and bill size and shape. Herring Gull (HERG) (*smithsonianus*) ruled out by mantle color and leg color. Other, darker forms of HERG ruled out by size (they should be larger) and wingtip pattern. Slaty-backed Gull (SBGU) eliminated by wing pattern (number of mirrors and color of secondaries, the visible parts of which should be mostly white), mantle color (the bird was not virtually black-backed), and leg color. Kelp Gull (KEGU) ruled out by bill (size and shape) and by mantle color. Great Black-backed Gull eliminated by size, leg color, and by upperparts color and pattern.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): No vocalizations heard.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen >85 *graellsii* LBBGs, bazillions of *smithsonianus* HERGs, >125 *vegae* HERGs, 10s of 1000s of GBBGs, 1000s of CAGUs, and >75 SBGUs. I have not seen any other of the darker, Asian HERGs, nor have I seen KEGU.

Light conditions: sun to my left**Optical equipment used:** Leica 32x and Swarovski 8x42

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest distance at about 500 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Doug Faulkner

Other observers who saw the bird independently: Brandon Percival, Paul Hurtado, Mark Janos, among others

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph the bird.

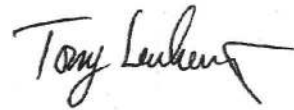
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: none

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:



Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: 25 December 2000 from notes written about eight hours after sighting